Chemical reactions, technology and society



Benefits

Medicines, fertilisers, plastics, building materials and most of our energy.



Greenhouse effect

Burning fossil fuels releases CO_2, which traps heat and causes climate change.

✓ renewable energy, planting trees



Acid rain

Sulphur and nitrogen oxides from combustion react with water vapour and form acids.

✓ catalytic converters, cleaner fuels



Green chemistry

Designing reactions that use less energy and produce less waste.

✓ the chemistry of the future